

An Alternate Theory

Every alternate OS from Windows flops...

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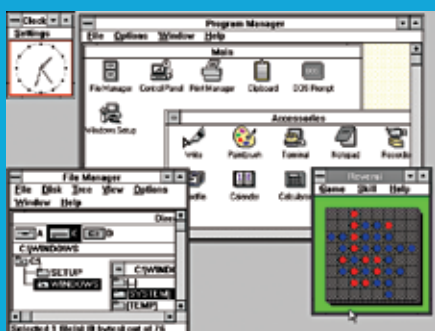
Everyone's heard the news about Windows 8 being a flop by now. Although Microsoft will tell you Windows 8's initial sales figures are even more than Windows 7, I'd suggest you take those figures with a pinch of salt. It's activations that tell us how many *actual people* are switching to Windows 8. Volume buyers such as Dell, HP, Acer, and others usually account for the initial huge demand of all Windows OSes. So 60 million licenses sold doesn't necessarily mean 60 million computers/computing devices are already running Windows 8 – it could be just 20, or 30, or 45 million, or any number... It occurred to me to check if there's a trend here – does every alternate OS from Microsoft bomb?

Windows 3.0

Rating: Average

The good old days of DOS, and the beginning of the Apple vs. Microsoft war... Windows 1.0, 2.0, 286/2.1 and 386/2.1 were released in really early days of the PC evolution. There wasn't even a world wide web back then... very early days. Windows 3.0 and 3.0a (with multimedia) were Microsoft's first commercial successes. Launched on May 22, 1990, Windows 3.0 was finally

a rival for Apple-made OSes. With a new GUI and proper support for Intel's spanking new (at the time) 80286 and 80386 CPUs, Windows 3.0 was pretty good. However, as successful as the next version it wasn't.



Windows 3.0 - with Reversi

Windows 3.1

Rating: Success



Windows 3.1 - the first success

The first really commercially successful version of Windows, it was the first to use the idea of the Windows Registry, introduced Windows users to True Type fonts, and my favourite addition – *Minesweeper*! Earlier versions used to have *Reversi* as the

bundled game. The biggest advantage Windows 3.1 had over 3.0, was Microsoft putting a line in the sand – 3.1 required you to have a minimum of a 286 CPU and 1 MB of RAM before it would install. Although this made an upgrade to 3.1 impossible if your PC was older, it prompted many to buy spanking new hardware, and the popularity of PCs skyrocketed. It was seriously popular – selling over 1 million copies in two months!

Windows 95

Rating: Average

Most people will disagree. Windows 95 sold 1 million copies in just 4 days, so sales were not the problem. However, while there's no denying why Windows 95 was great for the time... it was also buggy.



Windows 95 – Start me up!